Baofeng UV-5R Quick Guide

Trumpet Net

Most days you only need the first box. The back lists every menu and the setting we suggest.

THE EVERYDAY BASICS

1. **On and volume:** turn the top knob.
2. **Channel mode:** the screen should show a channel name with a small channel number on the right. If you see a bare frequency, press [VFO/MR].
3. **Pick a channel:** type three digits (`0 3 1` for channel 31) or use [▲] [▼].
4. **Talk:** hold **PTT** (push-to-talk, the big side button), wait one second, speak across the mic a few inches away, then let go. Wait for the other station before talking again.

BUTTONS

PTT	Push-to-talk. Hold to transmit.
CALL	Above PTT. Press: FM broadcast radio. **Hold: loud alarm.**
MONI	Below PTT. Press: flashlight. Hold: hear weak stations.
VFO/MR	Frequency mode (VFO, variable frequency oscillator) or channel mode (MR, memory recall).
A/B	Top line (A) or bottom line (B).
BAND	Frequency mode: VHF (very high frequency, 2m) or UHF (ultra high frequency, 70cm).
* **SCAN**	Hold: scan. Press again to stop.
# 🔒	Press: high/low power. Hold: lock or unlock the keypad.
MENU	Open settings and confirm. **EXIT** backs out.

CHANGE ANY SETTING

1. Press [MENU], then type the menu number (`7` for dual watch).
2. Press [MENU] to open it.
3. Use [▲] [▼] to choose.
4. Press [MENU] to save, then [EXIT].

Some menus only work in frequency mode. Channel settings are set by CHIRP.

LISTEN TO TWO CHANNELS (DUAL WATCH)

1. **MENU 7 (TDR)** → ON.
2. Press [A/B] to pick a line, choose its channel. Repeat for the other line.
3. **MENU 34 (TDR-AB)** → OFF, so you answer on the line that just spoke. A or B always transmits on that line.
4. **MENU 21 / 22 (MDF-A, MDF-B)** → NAME, to show channel names.

It flips between the two fast. While one line is busy, the other is muted.

SCAN

In channel mode, hold [* SCAN]. The radio steps through the scan list (3, 20, 23, 38, 39, 40, 50, 60, 70, 80, 90, 100) and stops on any voice. **MENU 18 (SC-REV)** sets when it moves on: **TO** after 5 seconds, **CO** when the talking stops (best for us), **SE** stays put.

ADD A CHANNEL BY HAND

1. Press [VFO/MR] for frequency mode, then type the frequency (`146520`).
2. Repeater only: **MENU 25 (SFT-D)** shift `+` or `−`, **MENU 26 (OFFSET)** `00.600` on 2m, `05.000` on 70cm, **MENU 13 (T-CTCS)** tone.
3. Tone both ways (like TPT): also **MENU 11 (R-CTCS)**, same tone.
4. **MENU 27 (MEM-CH)**, pick an empty channel, [MENU] to store, [EXIT].
5. Press [VFO/MR] to go back to channels.

CTCSS (continuous tone-coded squelch system) is the "privacy code": a hidden tone that opens the other radio. It doesn't make you private. Names need CHIRP.

SOMETHING'S WRONG?

No sound	Turn up the volume. Hold MONI to check for weak signals. Squelch (MENU 0) should be 3–5.
Keys dead	Keypad is locked. Hold [#].
Beeps, no TX	Receive-only channel (weather), a frequency the radio won't allow, or BCL (MENU 23) on a busy channel.
Repeater quiet	Wrong tone or shift. Check the channel against the trifold.
Numbers, no names	Press [VFO/MR], or set MENU 21/22 to NAME.
Alarm going off	Press [CALL] again.
Wrong list	Channel 0 (or 108) should say `VER 15`. If not, reprogram with CHIRP.

NEVER

- **MENU 40 (RESET) → ALL** erases every channel. Only CHIRP can put them back.
- Transmit without the antenna on. It can damage the radio.
- Transmit on a ham or GMRS channel without the license, except when a life is in danger.

Menu numbers are for the standard UV-5R (also UV-5RA, 5R+, 5RE, which match closely). If a number seems off, go by the menu name on the screen. Printed side 2: every menu.

Every menu

Shaded = settings worth knowing · advanced = beyond this guide

#	SCREEN	WHAT IT DOES	SUGGEST
0	SQL	Squelch: how strong a signal must be before you hear it. Higher is quieter but misses weak stations.	**3–5**
1	STEP	Tuning step in frequency mode.	**12.5K (5K on 2m)**
2	TXP	Transmit power, high or low. Same as a short press of [#].	**LOW nearby, HIGH far**
3	SAVE	Battery saver: the receiver naps between checks.	**ON (default)**
4	VOX	Voice-operated transmit: talks when it hears you, no PTT. Easy to key up by accident.	**OFF**
5	WN	Wide or narrow bandwidth. FRS 8–14 and MURS 1–3 are narrow.	**advanced**
6	ABR	How long the backlight stays on, in seconds.	**5**
7	TDR	Dual watch: watch line A and line B. See side 1.	**your choice**
8	BEEP	Keypad beeps.	**OFF when quiet matters**
9	TOT	Time-out timer: stops transmitting after this many seconds, so a stuck PTT can't jam a channel.	**60**
10	R-DCS	Receive digital code (DCS, digital-coded squelch). A digital privacy code.	**advanced**
11	R-CTCS	Receive tone (CTCSS privacy code). Only opens for radios sending this tone.	**advanced**
12	T-DCS	Transmit digital code.	**advanced**
13	T-CTCS	Transmit tone. Most repeaters need one.	**advanced**
14	VOICE	Spoken prompts when you press keys.	**OFF or ENG**
15	ANI-ID	Radio's ID code (ANI, automatic number identification). Read-only.	**—**
16	DTMFST	Whether you hear the touch-tones (DTMF, dual-tone multi-frequency) the radio sends.	**OFF**
17	S-CODE	Which ID code PTT-ID sends.	**—**
18	SC-REV	Scan resume: TO after 5 seconds, CO when talking stops, SE stops for good.	**CO**
19	PTT-ID	Sends an ID burst when you key up. Annoying to others.	**OFF**
20	PTT-LT	Delay before the PTT-ID burst.	**—**
21	MDF-A	What line A shows: frequency, channel number, or NAME.	**NAME**
22	MDF-B	Same for line B.	**NAME**
23	BCL	Busy channel lockout: won't transmit over someone. Also blocks you in an emergency.	**OFF**
24	AUTOLK	Locks the keypad after a few seconds idle.	**OFF (hold # instead)**
25	SFT-D	Repeater shift direction: + or − (or off). Frequency mode.	**for hand entry**
26	OFFSET	Repeater offset: 0.600 MHz on 2m, 5.000 on 70cm and GMRS.	**for hand entry**
27	MEM-CH	Save the line A frequency into a channel (000–127).	**for hand entry**
28	DEL-CH	Erase one channel. Careful: don't erase the list.	**—**
29	WT-LED	Screen color while idle.	**your choice**
30	RX-LED	Screen color while receiving.	**your choice**
31	TX-LED	Screen color while transmitting.	**your choice**
32	AL-MOD	What the alarm does: SITE sounds only here, TONE and CODE also transmit.	**SITE**
33	BAND	VHF or UHF for the frequency line.	**—**
34	TDR-AB	In dual watch, which line you transmit on after a call. OFF answers on the line that spoke.	**OFF**
35	STE	Cuts the short burst of noise at the end of a call (STE, squelch tail elimination), radio to radio.	**ON**
36	RP-STE	Same, through a repeater.	**OFF**
37	RPT-RL	Delay for the repeater's tail tone.	**OFF**
38	PONMSG	What shows at power on: FULL screen test or a MSG.	**your choice**
39	ROGER	Roger beep at the end of each transmission. Say "over" instead.	**OFF**
40	RESET	VFO resets settings only. **ALL erases every channel.**	**never ALL**

Menu list checked against Jim Unroe (KC9HI), "UV-5R Menu Definitions," miklor.com, and essexham.co.uk's UV-5R guide. Firmware differences between batches can move a menu or rename an option. "Advanced" settings are beyond the scope of this guide. The Trumpet Net list already sets them on each channel. www.deangadberry.com/trumpetnet